

CONTEMPORARY HORECA SCENE

Trends · Design & Atmosphere · Neurogastronomy · Technology · World's Best Restaurants & Bars

A 12-week elective module that reads the global hospitality industry through its rankings, venues, people and technologies — built for the next generation of hospitality leaders.

AUTHOR & COURSE LEADER

Egor Tarasenko

Master in Business Management — Hotel Institute Montreux Alumnus

Montreux · 2026

12 weeks · 36 contact hours · English

Why this course — and why now

The global scene is moving faster than the curriculum

“The world's best hospitality is being redefined right now — in Lima, Hong Kong, Dubai, Oslo and São Paulo. This course brings the frontier into the classroom.”

Nº 1

BAR LEONE, HONG KONG

First Asian bar ever crowned The World's Best Bar (2025)

Nº 1

MAIDO, LIMA

World's Best Restaurant 2025 — Latin America leads the table

51

COUNTRIES AT WORLD CLASS

Global bartending finals 2025, Toronto — won by Norway

\$2M

PROJECTED IMPACT

50 Best week in Lima, Nov 2026 — rankings drive tourism

- Rankings (Michelin, The 50 Best, GreatList) have become industry infrastructure: they move tourism, investment and careers.
- Technology — from AI-generated serves to revenue management — is reshaping operations and creativity at the same time.
- Students need a live map of the industry: this course updates every year with the latest lists, ceremonies and case venues.

About the author

An alumnus proposal — giving back to the institute



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Egor Tarasenko

AUTHOR & COURSE LEADER

Master in Business Management
Hotel Institute Montreux · Alumnus

- **Graduate of the Master in Business Management programme at Hotel Institute Montreux.**
The course is designed as an alumnus contribution: a bridge between HIM's Swiss hospitality tradition and today's global scene.
- **Focus: strategy, brand and economics of contemporary restaurants and bars.**
From concept and atmosphere engineering to unit economics and ranking strategy.
- **Built on primary industry sources, refreshed annually.**
MICHELIN Guide ceremonies, The 50 Best rankings and stories, GreatList expert reviews, Diageo World Class programmes.
- **Delivery: lectures + case labs + sensory practice + guest speakers.**
Industry practitioners join live or online; students work with real lists and real venues.

Course at a glance

One elective — a full tour of the contemporary scene

12

WEEKS

Semester elective, weeks 1–12 of the term

36

CONTACT HOURS

12 sessions × 3 hours: lecture + case + lab

5+1

MODULES

Five thematic modules and a final pitch day

EN

LANGUAGE

English; key sources and guest speakers

BBA · MIB

AUDIENCE

Bachelor and master students of hospitality & business

4

ASSESSMENT BLOCKS

Participation, field notes, module tasks, final pitch

Positioning: a business-perspective tour of the contemporary HoReCa scene — what the world's best venues do, why guests love them, and how rankings, design, science and technology create competitive advantage.

Learning outcomes

What students will be able to do after 12 weeks

01 Navigate the global ranking ecosystem

Michelin, The 50 Best, GreatList, World Class — how they work and how to use them in marketing and strategy.

02 Analyse HoReCa trends

Turn macro-trends — experience economy, anti-luxury, mindfulness — into concrete business decisions.

03 Design venue concepts

Interior, light, sound, scent and guest journey (CJM) — atmosphere as a managed product.

04 Apply neurogastronomy

Multisensory design of menus, serves and service: from plate weight to sound pairing.

05 Evaluate technology & AI

Reservations, revenue management, kitchen automation, data personalisation — with an ethics filter.

06 Pitch at world level

Develop and defend a venue concept benchmarked against the world's best bars and restaurants.

Course map

Five modules, one arc: from trends to a world-class concept

#	Module	Weeks	Core question	Signature cases
1	Contemporary HoReCa Trends	1–3	Where is the industry heading?	50 Best week in Lima; Californios ★★★; Gerbou
2	Venue Design & Atmosphere	4–5	What makes a space unforgettable?	GreatList criteria; Himkok; Hanu Dubai
3	Neurogastronomy & Guest Experience	6–7	How do senses shape taste?	Spence's gastrophysics; World Class multisensory
4	Technology & Automation	8–9	What should be human, what — smart?	AI-inspired serve (Don Julio 1942); Sesto Senso Academy
5	World's Leading Restaurants & Bars	10–12	Who sets the global standard?	Maido; Bar Leone; Myojaku; Felice Capasso
+	Final Pitch Day	12	Can your venue win the world stage?	Student concepts judged by an expert panel

MODULE 1 · WEEKS 1–3

Contemporary HoReCa Trends

Lecture seminars: reading the industry's present and near future

TOPICS

- Experience economy: dining as theatre — chef's tables, counters, storytelling formats.
- Anti-luxury & casualization: «cocktail popolari» — refinement without pretension.
- From sustainability to mindfulness: the Green Star evolves into Michelin's «Mindful Voices».
- Regional cuisines go global: Californios — the world's first three-star Mexican restaurant.
- Gastronomy tourism & city branding: 50 Best week brings ~\$2M of spending to Lima.
- New gravity: Asia, the Middle East and Latin America lead the rankings.
- Hotel F&B; renaissance: hotel bars and dining rooms back on the world lists.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- The 50 Best Restaurants 2026 ceremony — Lima, 4 Nov 2026: the course follows it live.
- Tuju (São Paulo) — Art of Hospitality 2026: fewer guests, menus themed around climate.
- Gerbou (Dubai) — Prix Versailles 2025 for architecture; Emirati cuisine as fine dining.

KEY QUESTION

If a venue opens today, which trends will still matter in 2030?

MODULE 2 · WEEKS 4-5

Venue Design & Atmosphere

Concept, architecture, interiors, senses — atmosphere as an engineered product

TOPICS

- Concept & narrative: the venue as a story guests retell.
- Space & ergonomics: layout, flow, comfort — a GreatList selection criterion.
- Light, acoustics, scent: the invisible layers of hospitality.
- Tableware & tactile design: weight, texture, temperature.
- Service choreography: rhythm of the evening, «invisible» service.
- Design awards as industry signal: Prix Versailles, Best Bar Design.
- Practice: atmosphere audit of Montreux venues against expert criteria.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- GreatList criteria: design & ergonomics; atmosphere «from scent to music»; full guest CJM.
- Himkok (Oslo) — Best Bar Design: a sustainable reimagining of a 200-year-old space.
- Hanu (Dubai) — Seoul aesthetics: charcoal grills, dark wood, bronze doors.

KEY QUESTION

Can atmosphere be measured — and can it be managed like a P&L; line?

MODULE 3 · WEEKS 6-7

Neurogastronomy & Guest Experience

How the brain eats: multisensory science for menus, serves and service

TOPICS

- Gastrophysics basics: crossmodal correspondences (Spence, Oxford).
- Sound & taste: sonic seasoning; music changes perceived flavour.
- Colour, shape and weight of tableware; plating geometry.
- Menu psychology: naming, layout, price anchors, choice architecture.
- Memory & emotion: hospitality that creates «Proust moments».
- Peak-end rule: designing the guest journey's strongest moments.
- Sensory lab: a guided tasting with controlled variables.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- World Class 2025: The Singleton multisensory challenge — cocktail «Between Us» with a custom record sleeve for «That's Amore».
- Tuju: radical personalisation — reading glasses, children's drawing kit, menus of rain and wind.
- Bar Leone: simplicity as a sensory strategy — «cocktails for the people».

KEY QUESTION

What does your venue taste like — before the first bite is served?

MODULE 4 · WEEKS 8-9

Technology & Automation

What should remain human — and what should be smart

TOPICS

- Reservations & waitlist systems; dynamic pricing; revenue management.
- Kitchen & floor automation: robotics, KDS, inventory, waste control.
- Data & CRM: personalisation at the level of a regular guest.
- AI in creativity: concept art, menu R&D, content — and its limits.
- Delivery, dark kitchens and omnichannel models.
- Education tech: academies of spirits & wine (Sesto Senso).
- Ethics & future of work: humane workplaces in a high-pressure industry.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- World Class 2025: Don Julio 1942 challenge — a serve created from an original AI artwork.
- Felice Capasso: Sesto Senso Academy — bartender education as a business model.
- 50 Best «war room»: how rankings themselves use data, voting and media technology.

KEY QUESTION

Where does technology amplify hospitality — and where does it kill it?

MODULE 5 · WEEKS 10–12

World's Leading Restaurants & Bars

Deep dives into the institutions and venues setting the global standard

TOPICS

- MICHELIN anatomy: stars, Bib Gourmand, special awards, inspector method.
- The 50 Best Academy: who votes, how lists change markets.
- Bar scene: World's 50 Best Bars, hotel bars, speakeasies.
- World Class: 16 seasons, 450,000+ bartenders, «drink better, not more».
- Regional scenes: Europe · Asia · Americas · Middle East.
- GreatList geography: Moscow — Dubai — Doha — Bangkok — Shanghai.
- Final pitch: student concepts vs world benchmarks.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- Mado (Lima) — World's №1 Restaurant 2025; four Lima venues in the top 50.
- Bar Leone (Hong Kong) — World's Best Bar 2025, first Asian №1, two years after opening.
- Myojaku (Tokyo) — promoted to Three MICHELIN Stars in the 2026 guide.

KEY QUESTION

What do all №1 venues share — and can it be taught?

The ranking ecosystem

Four institutions the course is built on — and how they differ

Institution	What it evaluates	Method	Status 2026
MICHELIN Guide	Cuisine quality & consistency	Anonymous inspectors; ★–★★★★, Bib Gourmand, Green Star, special awards	City & country guides worldwide; 2026 reveals: Tokyo, California, Toronto
The 50 Best (The 50)	Restaurants & bars as experiences	Anonymous global academy; restaurants — 8 best experiences; bars — 600+ experts, 7 votes each	Restaurant ceremony: Lima, 4 Nov 2026; Bars 2026: 51–100 already revealed
GreatList	Best restaurants of global cities	100+ experts, anonymous visits, self-paid bills; criteria: food, service CJM, design, atmosphere	Russia, UAE, Qatar, Thailand, China; Singapore & Seoul coming soon
Diageo World Class	Bartending craft & innovation	National finals → global finals; 51 countries in 2025; expert jury of venue owners	16th season; winner 2025: Felice Capasso (Norway)

Case: The World's 50 Best Restaurants

Revealed in Turin, June 2025 — next chapter: Lima, 4 November 2026

#	Restaurant	City	#	Restaurant	City
1	Maido	Lima	6	Gaggan	Bangkok
2	Asador Etxebarri	Atxondo	7	Sézanne	Tokyo
3	Quintonil	Mexico City	8	Table by Bruno Verjus	Paris
4	DiverXO	Madrid	9	Kjolle	Lima
5	Alchemist	Copenhagen	10	Don Julio	Buenos Aires

- Latin America sets the tone: N°1 and N°3, plus four Lima venues in the top 50.
- Voters receive no formal criteria — they name their eight best experiences of the year.
- 2026 Art of Hospitality Award: Tuju (São Paulo) — service as radical personalisation.
- Class use: students predict the 2026 list before the Lima ceremony, then score themselves.

Case: The MICHELIN Guide

From tyre-maker's guide to the industry's most cited rating

— The star anatomy.

★ — very good cuisine; ★★ — worth a detour; ★★★ — worth a special journey; plus Bib Gourmand and special awards (Service, Sommelier, Young Chef).

— Tokyo 2026.

Myojaku promoted to Three Stars; 18 new stars; Service and Sommelier awards — the world's deepest starred scene.

— California 2026.

Californios becomes the first Mexican restaurant in the world with Three Stars.

— Toronto 2026.

Restaurant Pearl Morissette retains two stars — Canada's benchmark.

— Sustainability in motion.

Green Star transitions into the «Mindful Voices» initiative — pioneers of new gastronomy.

— The Moscow page.

Debut 2021: first stars in Russia & CIS history; guide suspended in 2022 — a case study in rankings and geopolitics.

Case: The World's 50 Best Bars 2025

Ceremony in Hong Kong: for the first time, №1 goes to Asia

#	Bar	City	#	Bar	City
1	Bar Leone	Hong Kong	6	Connaught Bar	London
2	Handshake Speakeasy	Mexico City	7	Moebius Milano	Milan
3	Sips	Barcelona	8	Line	Athens
4	Paradiso	Barcelona	9	Jigger & Pony	Singapore
5	Tayēr + Elementary	London	10	Tres Monos	Buenos Aires

- Bar Leone: №1 only two years after opening — «cocktail popolari», classics without pretension.
- Best Bar Design: Himkok (Oslo) — sustainable reimagining of a 200-year-old space.
- Sustainable Bar: The Cambridge Public House (Paris); first-ever Best Bar in Africa (Hero Bar, Nairobi) and Middle East (Mimi Kakushi, Dubai).

Cases: Diageo World Class & GreatList

People and expertise behind the headlines

DIAGEO WORLD CLASS 2025 · TORONTO

- Winner: Felice Capasso (Norway) — Nedre Løkka Cocktailbar, Oslo; founder of Sesto Senso Academy.
- Challenges: reimagined classics with Johnnie Walker Black Label; Don Julio 1942 serve inspired by AI artwork; multisensory Singleton serve.
- Jury: Eric Van Beek (Handshake Speakeasy), Monica Berg (Tayēr + Elementary), Ago Perrone (Connaught Bar).
- Mission: «drink better, not more» — 450,000+ bartenders trained.

GREATLIST · INTERNATIONAL RESTAURANT GUIDE

- Founded 2022; 100+ experts; anonymous visits, self-paid bills, repeat visits at different hours.
- Criteria: food & chef imagination; service across the full CJM; design & ergonomics; atmosphere — from scent to music.
- Geography: Moscow, St. Petersburg, Yekaterinburg, Kazan, Nizhny Novgorod, Russian Far East, Dubai, Doha, Bangkok, Hong Kong, Shanghai (+ Singapore & Seoul soon).
- GreatList Sessions 2025: guest dinners by world chefs — a format for field study.

Teaching methodology

Every session: 45' lecture · 75' cases · 60' practice — plus the through-project «My Venue»

1

Case method on live venues

Maido, Bar Leone, Tuju, Himkok, Hanu — dissected as business systems: concept, economics, guest journey.

2

Sensory labs

Guided tastings testing neurogastronomy hypotheses: light, sound, weight, naming.

3

Atmosphere audits

Field teams evaluate Montreux & Riviera venues against GreatList-style criteria and present findings.

4

Guest speakers

Chefs, bartenders, restaurateurs and ranking experts — live or online, from the course's industry network.

5

Rankings war room

Real-time analysis of new lists — including the Lima ceremony of 4 November 2026.

6

Peer review culture

Week-1 «favourite venue» talk sets the bar; every «My Venue» page is reviewed by a partner before it reaches the lecturer.

Practical core: «My Venue»

Every student builds their own bar or restaurant — from idea to «open & operate»

WEEK 1 · ASSIGNMENT 0

Each student presents their favourite bar or restaurant (5 min) through the course's four lenses — trends, design & atmosphere, senses, rankings. One change they would make as the owner.

Wk	Milestone of the student's own concept	Wk	Milestone of the student's own concept
2	Concept & USP; three world benchmarks	8	Operations & technology: service model, stack, human line
3	Trend memo: which trends the concept rides	9	AI & ethics page of the concept
4	Design & narrative: interior «three scenes», zoning	10	Marketing I: guest shifts & residencies, alcohol-brand partnerships, 90-day launch
5	Atmosphere spec + audit of a real Montreux venue	11	Marketing II: 3-year roadmap to a chosen guide or list
6	Three signature serves built on sensory effects	12	Final pitch «Open & Operate» before an expert panel
7	Menu architecture, pricing, an A/B test		

Format: one A4 page or two slides added every week; peer-reviewed in pairs. The folder of 11 pages becomes the final concept deck.

Assessment

Continuous, practice-based, industry-style

Component	Weight	What students do
Assignment 0 & participation	10%	Week-1 «favourite venue» talk; case discussions, war-room sessions
Field Notes (weekly)	15%	One-page weekly reviews: a venue visit, a ranking change, an industry article
«My Venue» weekly milestones	35%	Eleven weekly pages of the student's own concept; peer-reviewed
Final pitch «Open & Operate»	40%	Full concept deck defended before an expert panel

Grading follows HIM regulations. Late work policy and AI-use disclosure follow the institute's academic integrity rules.

Final pitch: «Open & Operate»

Each student's own venue: restaurant, bar, hotel F&B, pop-up — ready to open

01

USP & STORY

One-sentence USP, audience, price point — why the world should care.

02

DESIGN & ATMOSPHERE

Concept board: interior, light, sound, scent, tableware — managed senses.

03

MENU, BEVERAGE & OPERATIONS

Neurogastronomy-backed serves; service model, tech stack, unit-economics sketch.

04

MARKETING ENGINE

Guest shifts & chef residencies (GreatList Sessions model); alcohol-brand partnerships (World Class formats); 90-day launch plan.

05

ROADMAP TO RECOGNITION

One target guide or list — and a 3-year plan to earn it.

The panel includes invited industry professionals. The strongest concept is recommended for HIM student hospitality competitions and accelerator formats.

Fit with HIM & resources

The course extends the institute's ecosystem, not duplicates it

INTEGRATION WITH HIM

- Swiss hospitality tradition meets the global scene — the same duality HIM stands for.
- Montreux Jazz Festival field module: festival F&B; operations (HIM's long-standing partner).
- Connects to existing curriculum: marketing, revenue management, innovation, luxury business.
- Career bridge: students learn what world-class venues look for in managers and interns.

COURSE RESOURCES

- Live data: MICHELIN Guide reveals, The 50 rankings & stories, GreatList encyclopedia, World Class materials.
- Reading list: Guidara «Unreasonable Hospitality»; Meyer «Setting the Table»; Spence «Gastrophysics»; Pine & Gilmore «The Experience Economy».
- Video: The 50 films and Talks; ceremony livestreams.
- Guest network: alumni and industry contacts of the course author.

Week-by-week plan

12 sessions · Thursdays 13:15–16:30 format (adjustable to HIM timetable)

Wk	Session
1	Introduction. Anatomy of contemporary HoReCa. Rankings as industry infrastructure.
2	Macro-trends I: experience economy, anti-luxury, casualization of fine dining.
3	Macro-trends II: mindfulness, regional cuisines go global, gastro-tourism & city branding.
4	Venue design: concept, architecture, interior, ergonomics (Prix Versailles; GreatList criteria).
5	Engineering atmosphere: light, sound, scent, tableware, service choreography. Field audit briefing.
6	Neurogastronomy I: multisensory perception, gastrophysics. Sensory lab.
7	Neurogastronomy II: menu psychology, pricing, peak-end design. World Class multisensory case.
8	Technology I: reservations, revenue management, kitchen & floor automation, CRM.
9	Technology II: AI in creativity and operations; ethics and the future of hospitality work.
10	World restaurants: MICHELIN & 50 Best deep dive; Europe · Asia · Americas · Middle East scenes.
11	World bars: 50 Best Bars, World Class, hotel bars; Moscow–Dubai–Doha via GreatList.
12	Final Pitch Day: «Your Venue on the World Stage». Course wrap-up.

CONTEMPORARY HORECA SCENE · COURSE PROPOSAL

Let's bring the world's best hospitality to Montreux.

Egor Tarasenko

Author & Course Leader · Master in Business Management, Hotel Institute Montreux Alumnus

email · LinkedIn — to be added Montreux, 2026

Sources: MICHELIN Guide · The 50 Best (the50.com) · GreatList (greatlist.ru) · Diageo World Class (diageo.com)